

» ALISMATALES



2 m
6½ ft

SOUTH AMERICAN WATERWEED
Egeria densa

F: Hydrocharitaceae

Native from Brazil to Uruguay, this underwater plant, grown by aquarists, has escaped to clog lakes and waterways across the temperate world.



TAPE GRASS

Vallisneria spiralis
F: Hydrocharitaceae

This submerged, freshwater plant is found from southern N. America to Colombia. Its male flowers break loose and float, perhaps encountering female ones to pollinate.



BROAD-LEAVED PONDWEED

Potamogeton natans
F: Potamogetonaceae

This freshwater plant has broad surface leaves and grass-like underwater ones. It is common across the northern hemisphere.



FLOATING LEAF

20 cm
8 in

leaves brown with age



THREE-PETALLED FLOWER

FROGBIT

Hydrocharis morsus-ranae
F: Hydrocharitaceae

This free-floating freshwater plant from Eurasia spreads via horizontal underwater stems. Male and female flowers grow on separate plants.



NEPTUNE GRASS
Posidonia oceanica
F: Posidoniaceae

This seagrass sometimes forms dense patches on sandy seabeds, at depths of up to 35 m (115 ft) beneath the Mediterranean Sea.

tufts of ribbon-like leaves

1 m
3¼ ft

horizontal stem buried in sand

COMMON EELGRASS

Zostera marina
F: Zosteraceae

Growing on sandy sea floors across the northern hemisphere, this grass-like plant forms underwater "meadows" that are an important marine habitat.



1 m
3¼ ft

ASPARAGALES

This diverse order of 14 families includes familiar garden flowers such as daffodils and irises, desert-adapted plants such as agaves, and a few trees. Some of its members were previously classified in the order Liliales, but modern genetic techniques have changed our understanding of these interrelationships. The order also includes the highly specialized orchid family.



dense flowerhead of small, bell-shaped flowers

80 cm
32 in

ROUND-HEADED LEEK

Allium sphaerocephalon
F: Amaryllidaceae

This European relative of the onion favours limestone soils. Gardeners grow it for its colourful, tightly packed flowerheads.



1 m/3¼ ft

edible bulb

ONION

Allium cepa
F: Amaryllidaceae

Evidence from ancient Egypt shows that the onion has been cultivated for at least 5,000 years.



45 cm
20 in

RAMSONS

Allium ursinum
F: Amaryllidaceae

Related to and smelling of garlic, this plant often carpets the floors of European woodlands in spring with its broad green leaves.



funnel-shaped, light to deep blue flowers

60 cm
23½ in

AFRICAN LILY

Agapanthus africanus
F: Amaryllidaceae

Native to South Africa, this plant has a tall, flowering stem and narrow, arching leaves. It can survive fires in its native habitat, regrowing from a fleshy underground stem.



20 cm
8 in

SNOWDROP

Galanthus nivalis
F: Amaryllidaceae

The early spring flowers of this shade-tolerant European native have three white sepals that are much longer than the three inner petals.